

AGENTIC-ARBITER -- FREE-COOLING DECISION REPORT

Data centres over-cool, continuously, because nobody can promise them the hours ahead. A chiller plant needs hours of notice to change mode, and a thermometer only ever reports NOW -- so the mechanical chillers keep running through hours that outside air could have cooled for free. FortyGuard closes that gap with heat intelligence 2 m above the ground, the height a ground-mounted condenser actually breathes. This agent turns that forecast into an hour-by-hour schedule carrying a calibrated safety bound.

THE SITE

Location NCSA Petascale Computing Facility, IL -- station KCMI, America/Chicago
Building OSM 138260136
NCSA Petascale Computing Facility
Facade gap not applicable -- one building, no second facade
Weather record 43,310 real hourly records from KCMI
Plume physics NOT MODELLED. No other tagged data centre lies inside the solver's validated range, so there is no neighbour intake for a plume to arrive at: the quantity does not exist here rather than being unmeasured. This is a statement about the model's domain, not a claim that recirculation here is zero. A building's own exhaust re-entering its own intake is not modelled at any site in this project.

FortyGuard data: weather and geometry are this site's own; the four measured FortyGuard level offsets and the N-26 coverage record are Ashburn's, because only Ashburn has forecast/outcome day pairs. Quote the hours for this site; quote the coverage for Ashburn.

THIS REPORT IS A SNAPSHOT, NOT THE LIVE PAGE

The interface recomputes the decision for whatever configuration a reader selects. This file was generated at build time for the ONE configuration named below, chosen because it is the configuration in which this site's agent does the most while still changing mode at least once. If the numbers on screen differ from the numbers here, the configuration differs -- compare the two lists before concluding anything else.

Day 2025-12-28 (crossing)
Plant limit 18.0 C
Notice required 3 h
Forecast skill 0.50 relative to persistence
Level anchor sensor
Condenser bank longest facade
Switch budget 2 mode changes per day
Minimum dwell 3 h
Max dew point gate off

WHAT THE AGENT DID ON THIS DAY

The agent ran free cooling for 8 of 24 hours with 1 mode change. That is 1 more than the reactive incumbent, at 0 unsafe hours against its 0. 7 hours were safe but still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them.

Agent 8 of 24 hours free cooling, 1 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)
Incumbent 7 of 24 hours free cooling, 2 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)
7 hour(s) passed every gate and still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them

EVERY HOUR, AND THE REASON FOR IT

hh	mode	safe	binding	bound	limit	actual	margin
00	mechanical	yes	switch budget	15.275	18.0	15.000	0.948
01	mechanical	yes	switch budget	15.280	18.0	15.000	0.879
02	mechanical	yes	switch budget	15.280	18.0	15.000	0.824
03	mechanical	yes	switch budget	15.280	18.0	15.000	0.770

04	mechanical	yes	switch budget	15.560	18.0	15.560	0.742
05	mechanical	yes	switch budget	15.280	18.0	15.000	0.685
06	mechanical	yes	switch budget	16.115	18.0	15.560	0.914
07	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.055	18.0	16.110	1.474
08	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	19.720	18.0	16.670	2.167
09	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	21.390	18.0	17.780	2.383
10	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	21.665	18.0	18.330	2.129
11	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	21.110	18.0	18.330	1.656
12	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	21.390	18.0	19.440	1.264
13	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	21.385	18.0	20.000	1.148
14	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	20.550	18.0	19.440	1.004
15	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	19.995	18.0	18.330	0.870
16	FREE	yes	-	16.115	18.0	11.110	0.850
17	FREE	yes	-	13.610	18.0	7.220	1.130
18	FREE	yes	-	10.555	18.0	2.780	1.415
19	FREE	yes	-	5.280	18.0	0.000	1.506
20	FREE	yes	-	3.055	18.0	-1.110	1.774
21	FREE	yes	-	0.280	18.0	-2.220	1.466
22	FREE	yes	-	-2.220	18.0	-4.440	1.031
23	FREE	yes	-	-2.780	18.0	-5.000	1.056

bound = the agent's 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air, forecast plus margin
actual = what the intake temperature turned out to be, from the station record
margin = group-conditional forecast error for that hour of day, plus plume spread

THE REASONING, HOUR BY HOUR

00:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.275 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

01:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.280 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

02:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.280 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

03:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.280 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

04:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.560 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes

per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

05:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.280 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

06:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 16.115 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

07:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.055 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.055 C. It would take a limit 0.055 C higher, or a bound 0.055 C tighter, to change this hour.

08:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 19.720 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 1.720 C. It would take a limit 1.720 C higher, or a bound 1.720 C tighter, to change this hour.

09:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 21.390 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 3.390 C. It would take a limit 3.390 C higher, or a bound 3.390 C tighter, to change this hour.

10:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 21.665 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 3.665 C. It would take a limit 3.665 C higher, or a bound 3.665 C tighter, to change this hour.

11:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 21.110 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 3.110 C. It would take a limit 3.110 C higher, or a bound 3.110 C tighter, to change this hour.

12:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 21.390 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 3.390 C. It would take a limit 3.390 C higher, or a bound 3.390 C tighter, to change this hour.

13:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 21.385 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 3.385 C. It would take a limit 3.385 C higher, or a bound 3.385 C tighter, to change this hour.

14:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 20.550 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 2.550 C. It would take a limit 2.550 C higher, or a bound 2.550 C tighter, to change this hour.

15:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 19.995 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 1.995 C. It would take a limit 1.995 C higher, or a bound 1.995 C tighter, to change this hour.

16:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 16.115 C, which is 1.885 C

under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 0.850 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 0.850 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction differs from the one planned for, at the measured spread of wind direction over this lead time.

17:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 13.610 C, which is 4.390 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.130 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.130 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction differs from the one planned for, at the measured spread of wind direction over this lead time.

18:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 10.555 C, which is 7.445 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.415 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.415 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction differs from the one planned for, at the measured spread of wind direction over this lead time.

19:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 5.280 C, which is 12.720 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.505 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.505 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction differs from the one planned for, at the measured spread of wind direction over this lead time.

20:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 3.055 C, which is 14.945 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.774 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.774 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction differs from the one planned for, at the measured spread of wind direction over this lead time.

21:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 0.280 C, which is 17.720 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.466 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.466 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction differs from the one planned for, at the measured spread of wind direction over this lead time.

22:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is -2.220 C, which is 20.220 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.031 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.031 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction differs from the one planned for, at the measured spread of wind direction over this lead time.

23:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is -2.780 C, which is 20.780 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.056 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.056 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction differs from the one planned for, at the measured spread of wind direction over this lead time.

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